

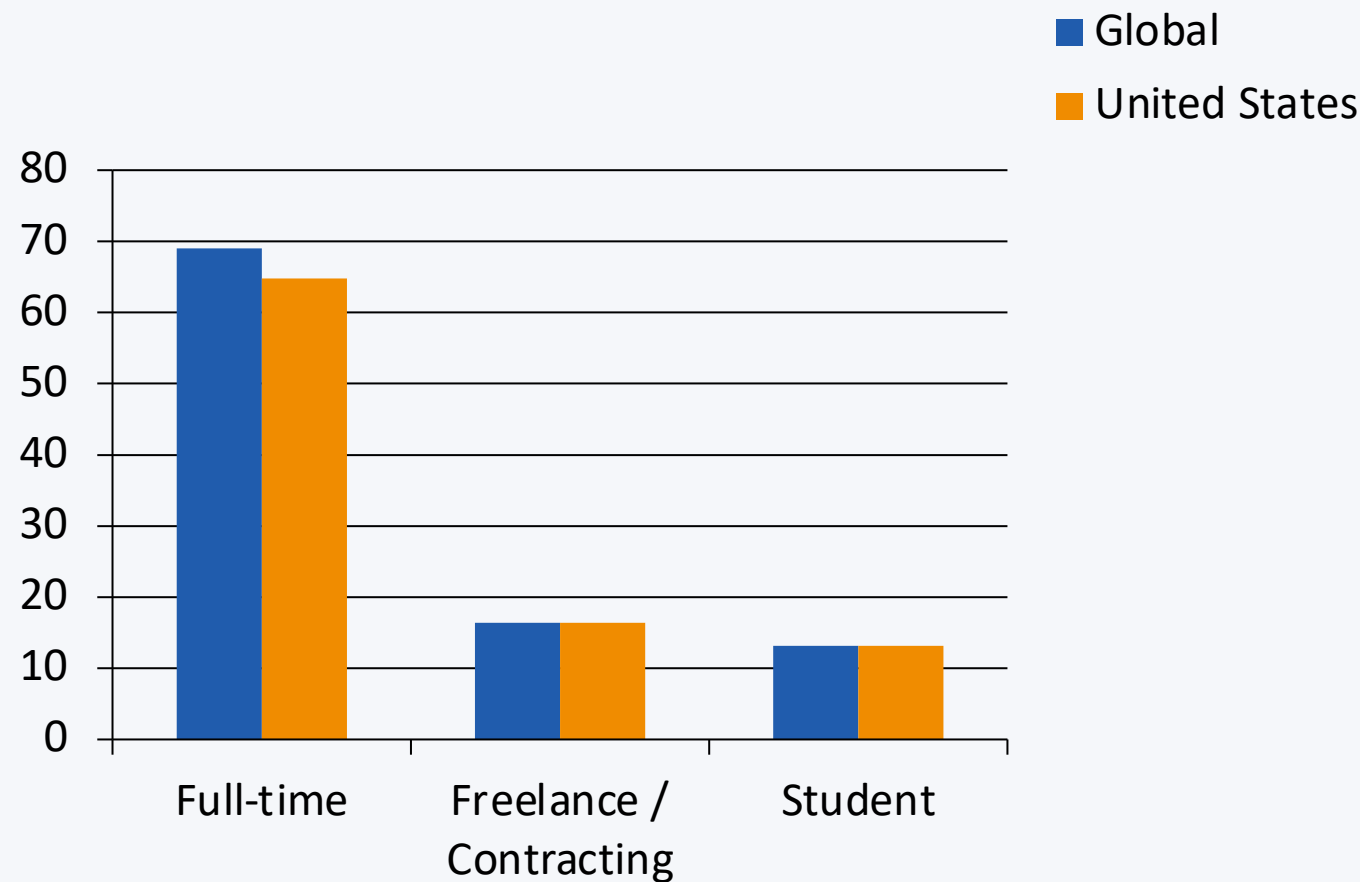
Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Developer Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Employment status breakdown — Global vs. United States, 2024



84%

of developers currently working
(full-time, part-time, or freelance)

69%

global full-time employment rate

64.8%

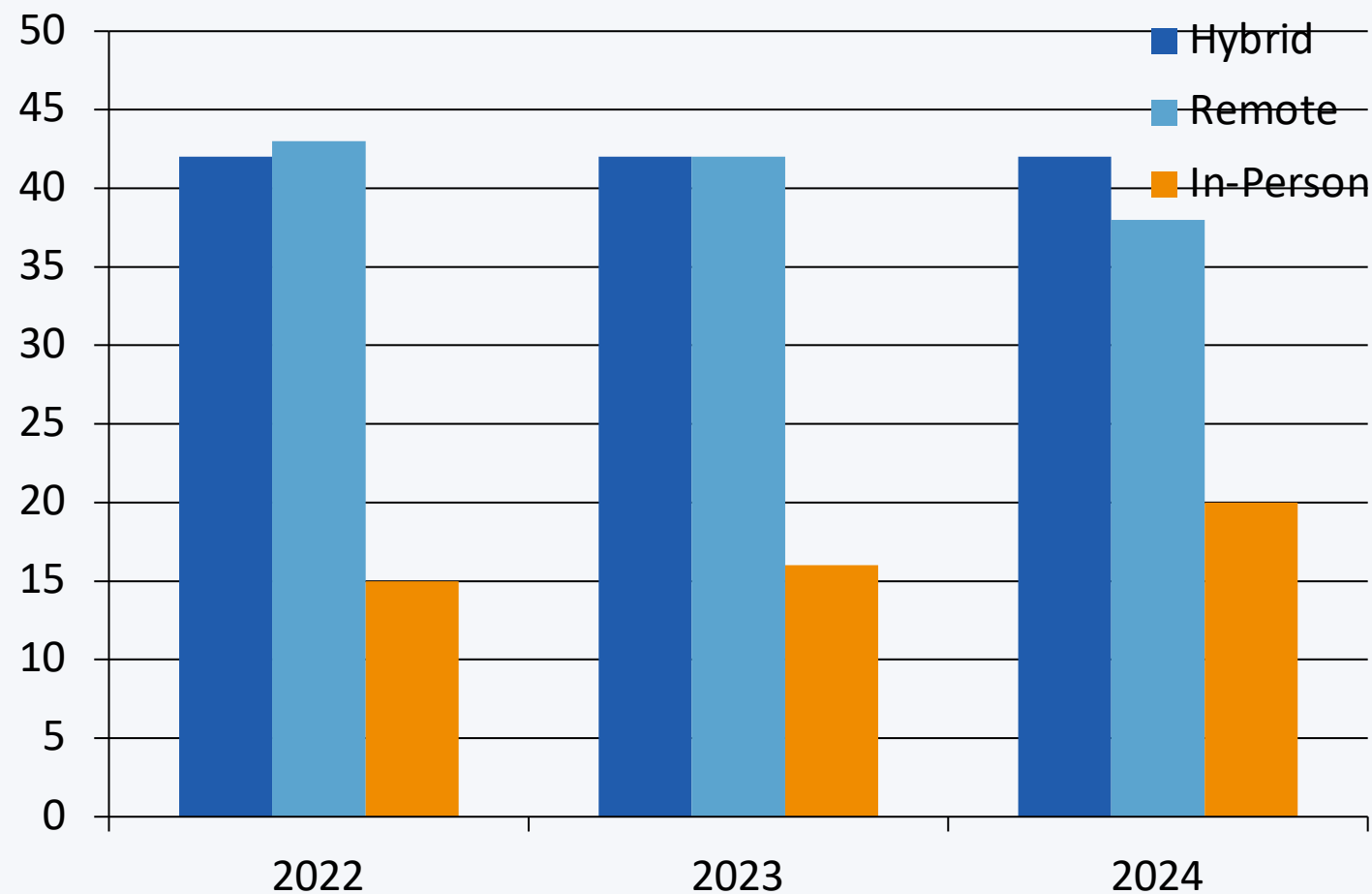
U.S. full-time rate in 2024
(down from 69% in 2023)

16.4%

independent contracting
or freelancing globally

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Three-year work-environment trend, 2022–2024



42%

Hybrid (2024)

Consistent with 2023 —
hybrid is the new normal

38%

Remote (2024)

Slight dip from 2023;
flexibility still dominant

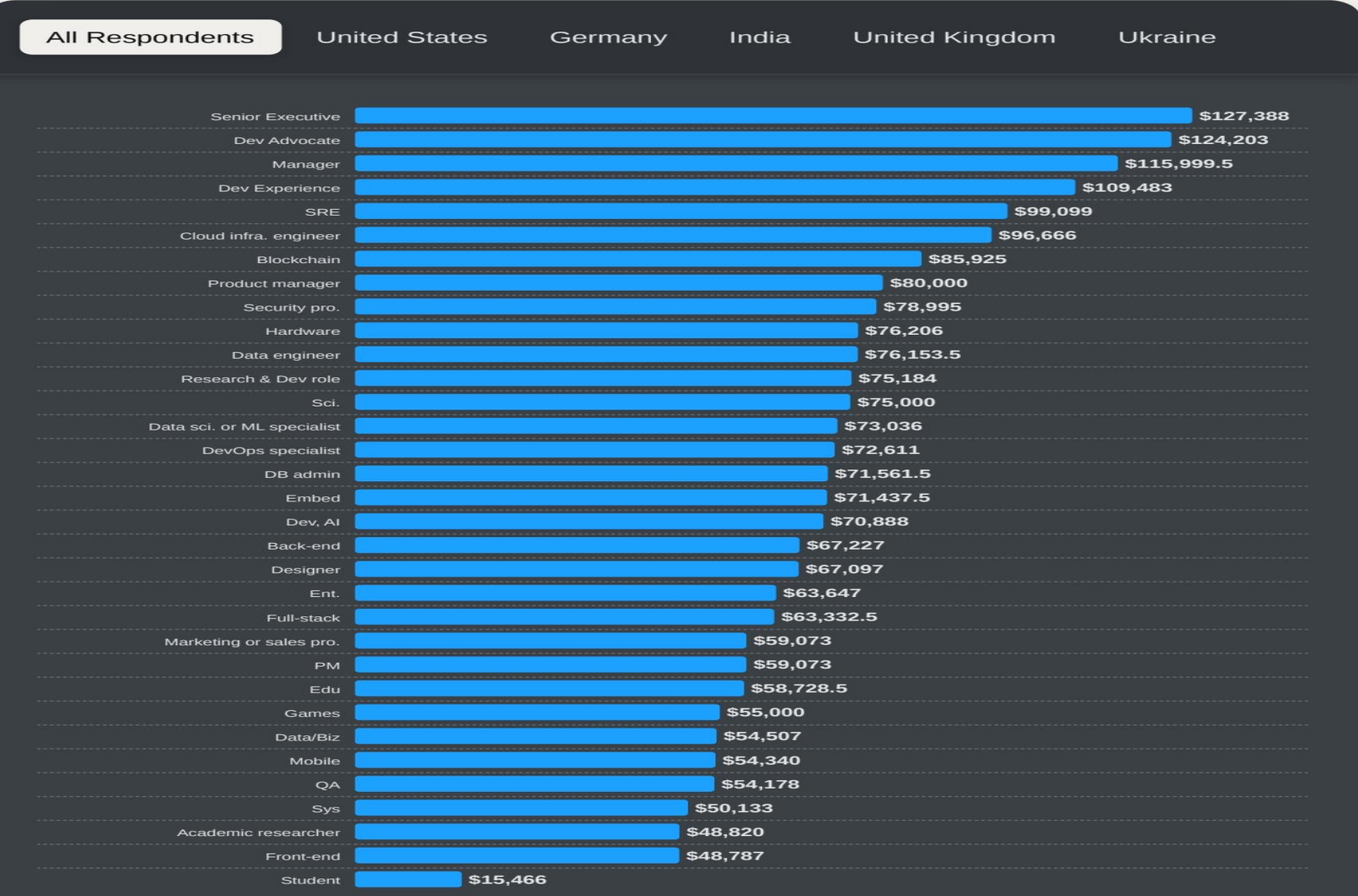
20%

In-Person (2024)

↑ from 15% in 2022
Third consecutive year of growth

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

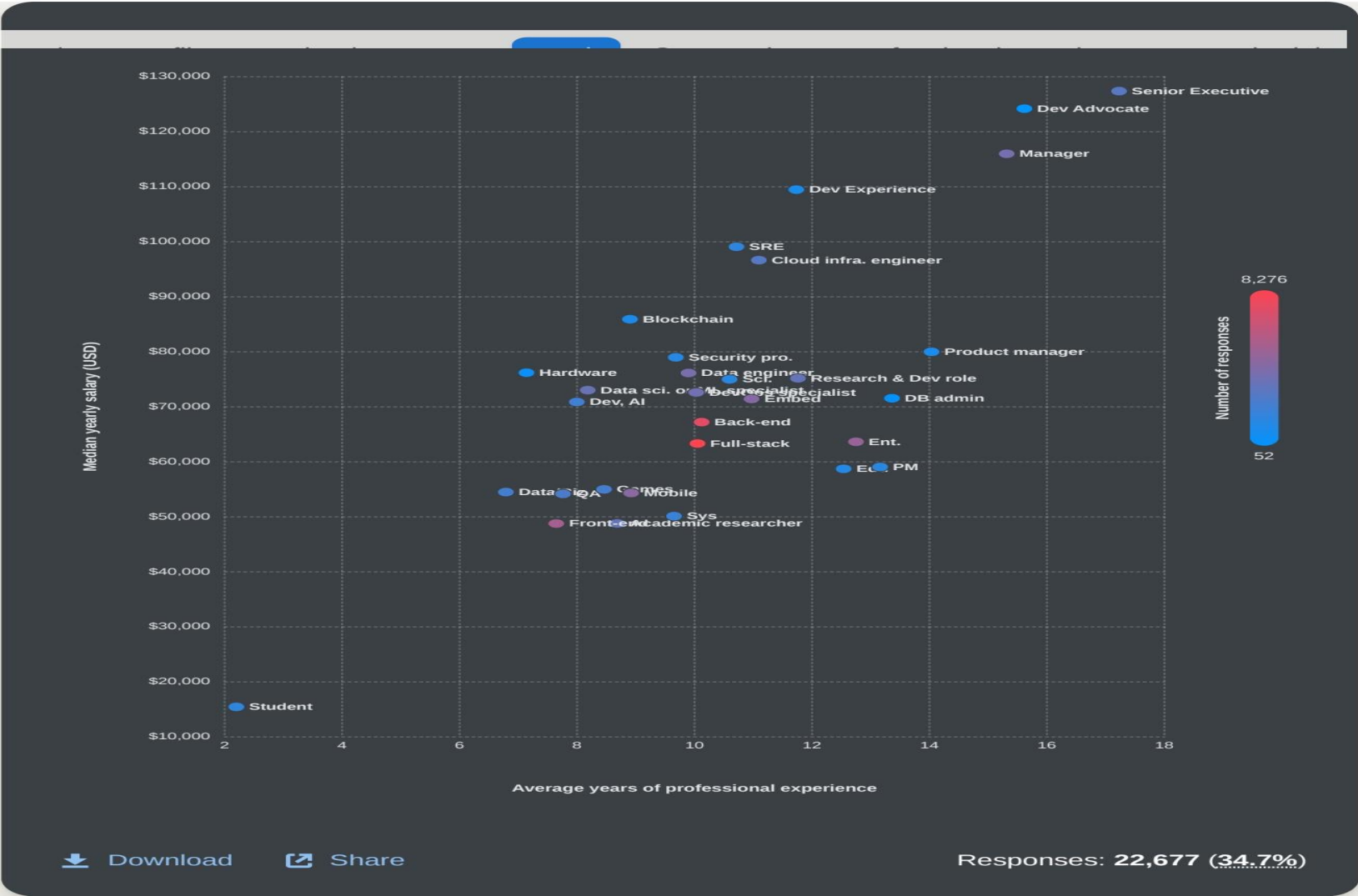
Median annual compensation (USD) by developer type — 22,677 salary responses



Top Roles by Median Salary	
Senior Executive	\$127,388
Dev Advocate	\$124,203
Manager	\$115,999
Dev Experience	\$109,483
SRE	\$99,099
Cloud Infra Engineer	\$96,666
Blockchain	\$85,925
Product Manager	\$80,000
Full-stack Dev	\$63,333
Front-end Dev	\$48,787
34.7% response rate n=22,677	

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Median salary vs. average years of experience by developer type



Key Observations

High-pay cluster

Senior Exec, Dev Advocate, and Manager: >\$115K with 15–17 yrs experience

Mid-tier technical

SRE & Cloud Infra: ~\$97-99K at ~10–13 yrs experience

Student outlier

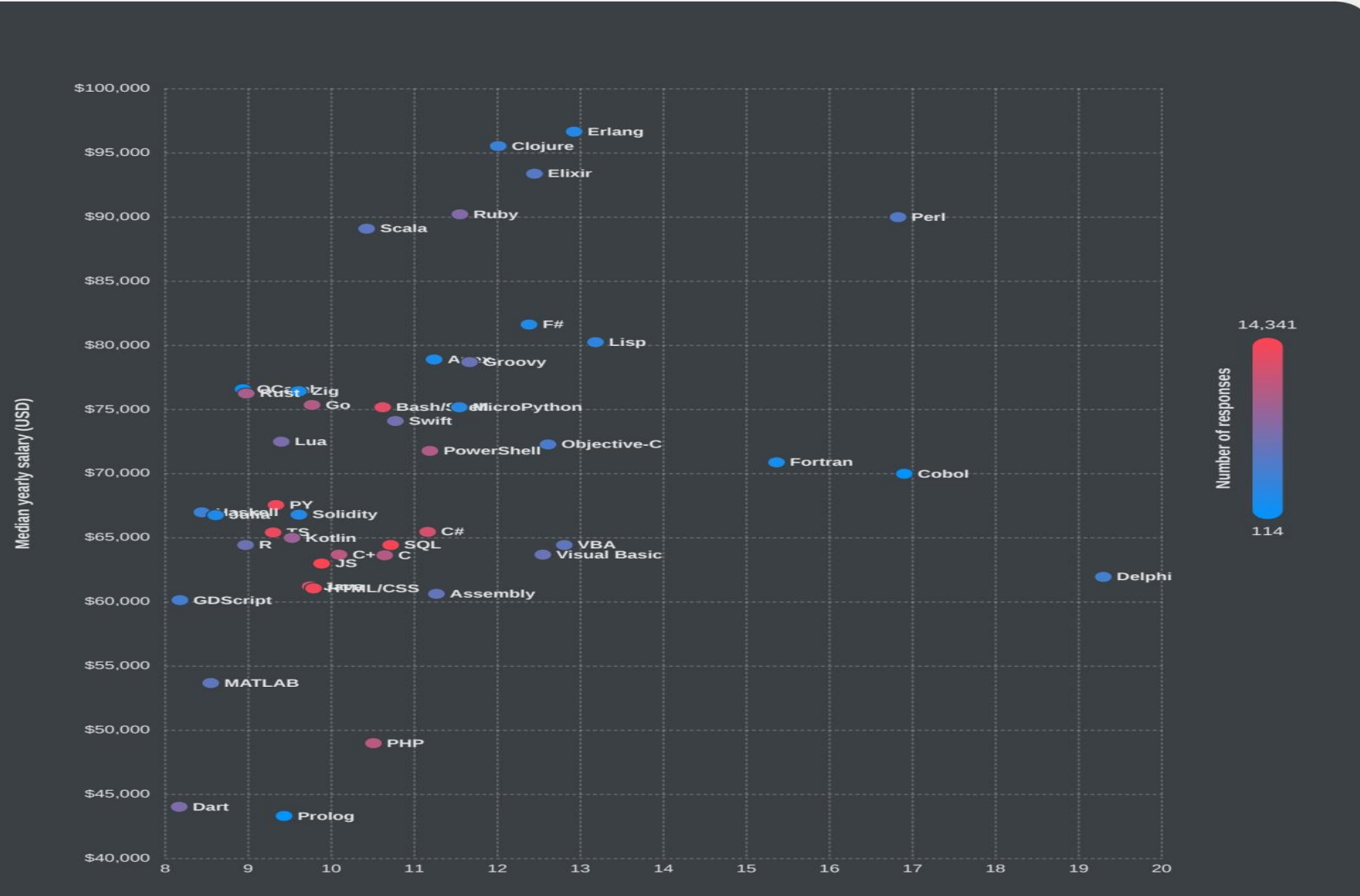
\$15,466 median with only ~2 yrs average experience

Salary gap widens

Each additional year of experience correlates with higher compensation

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Median salary vs. average experience by programming language — 2024 vs 2023 comparison

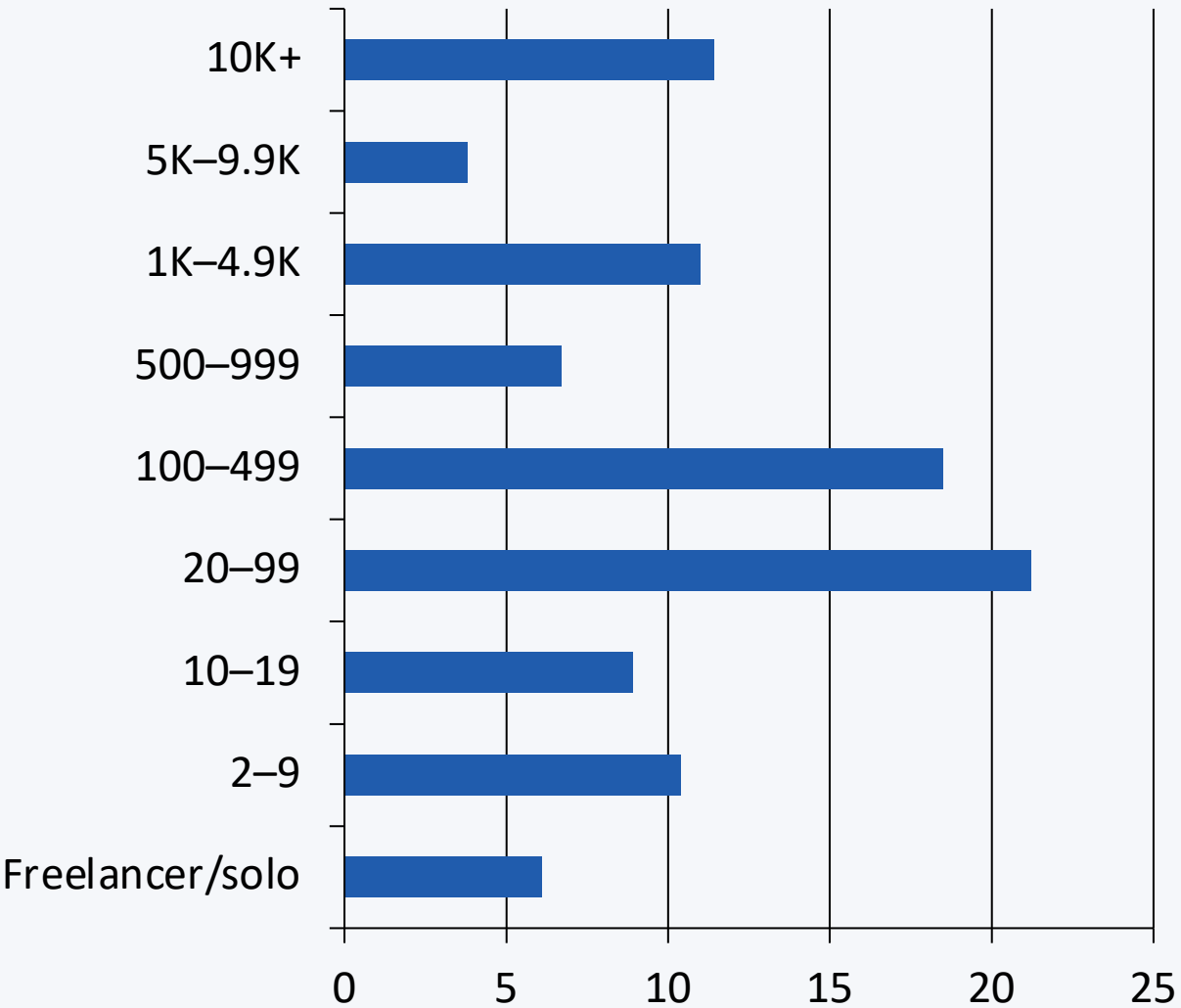


Salary Range by Language		
Erlang	~\$97,000	~12 yrs
Clojure	~\$95,000	~11 yrs
Elixir	~\$93,000	~11 yrs
Perl	~\$90,000	~19 yrs
Ruby	~\$89,000	~11 yrs
Go	~\$76,000	~9 yrs
Python	~\$67,000	~9 yrs
JavaScript	~\$64,000	~10 yrs
PHP	~\$49,000	~10 yrs
Dart	~\$44,000	~8 yrs
Prolog	~\$43,000	~9 yrs

⚠ Overall salary range down ~\$10K vs. 2023 (\$60–75K avg vs. \$70–85K in 2023)

47% Work at Sub-100-Employee Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company-size distribution and technology purchasing influence — n=42,827



Technology Purchasing Influence

- 62%** of developers have influence over tech purchases
- 99%** Senior executives influence purchasing decisions
- 87%** Engineering managers influence purchasing
- 77%** Product managers influence purchasing
- 60%** prefer a build-and-buy approach
- 75%** start with a free trial when evaluating tools
- 73%** ask other developers for tool recommendations

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

Actionable insights for engineering leaders and HR teams

1 Plan for a more flexible workforce

U.S. full-time employment fell 4 pp YoY to 64.8%. Budget for contractors and freelancers alongside FTEs — the shift is structural, not temporary.

2 Hybrid is the equilibrium; in-person mandates carry risk

Hybrid (42%) dominates for the second consecutive year. In-person grew to 20%, but mandating a full RTO may raise attrition risk among remote-accustomed talent.

3 Pay a premium for DevRel, SRE, and leadership

Senior Execs (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and Managers (\$116K) top the pay chart. SREs (\$99K) are the highest-paid purely technical role — budget accordingly.

4 Language specialization correlates with compensation

Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir developers earn >\$93K median. If recruiting for niche stacks, expect premium salaries — and note that overall pay ranges fell ~\$10K vs. 2023.

5 Engage developers directly in vendor conversations

62% of developers influence tech purchases; 73% trust peer recommendations. Vendor and tooling strategies should target ICs and senior devs, not just management.